

Table 5. Robustness of between-year network comparisons

Year comparison	Measure	Primary difference	A1 Direction match	A2 Matching proportion	A3 Matching proportion	Classification
2004-2012	Retained edges	+7	Yes	0.524	0.885	NOT_ROBUST
2004-2012	Global strength	+0.686	Yes	0.962	0.997	ROBUST
2012-2016	Retained edges	0	No	0.067	0.125	NOT_ROBUST
2012-2016	Global strength	+0.114	Yes	0.818	0.588	NOT_ROBUST
2016-2020	Retained edges	0	No	0.154	0.080	NOT_ROBUST
2016-2020	Global strength	+0.137	Yes	0.784	0.882	MIXED
2020-2024	Retained edges	+1	No	0.580	0.525	NOT_ROBUST
2020-2024	Global strength	-0.114	Yes	0.643	0.689	NOT_ROBUST
2004-2024	Retained edges	+8	Yes	0.998	1.000	ROBUST
2004-2024	Global strength	+0.823	Yes	1.000	1.000	ROBUST

Note. Differences are calculated as the later year minus the earlier year.
A1: full-sample networks with threshold = TRUE. A2 and A3: equal-N analyses with threshold = FALSE and threshold = TRUE, respectively. Each equal-N analysis used 1,000 repetitions with N = 789 per later-year sample; the 2004 sample remained fixed. Matching means reproducing the primary difference's positive, negative or zero direction; a primary difference of zero requires a repeated difference of zero. Classifications combine A1-A3 under the criteria specified in Methods; they are not significance tests.